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2027 CYCLE

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CUET UG

Political Science

Challenge to and Restoration of Congress System

Official Syllabus · Politics in India Since Independence · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Political Science syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline — Politics in India Since Independence)	Skills the questions test
Succession after Nehru	Political succession after Nehru — the transition to Lal Bahadur Shastri in 1964 and the 1966 contest between Indira Gandhi and Morarji Desai.	Tracing the democratic succession mechanisms, the 1965 crisis, and the role of the Congress Syndicate.
1967 Elections & Non-Congressism	Non-Congressism and the electoral upset of 1967 — economic crises, devaluation of the rupee, SVD coalition ministries, and political defections.	Analysing the 1967 "Political Earthquake", Rammanohar Lohia's ideological thesis, and the "Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram" phenomenon.
1969 Congress Split & Conscience Vote	Factional rivalry between Indira Gandhi and the Syndicate — the 10-Point Programme, 14 bank nationalisations, Privy Purses, 1969 Presidential election duel, and formal split.	Distinguishing Congress (O) from Congress (R), the role of V.V. Giri vs. Sanjiva Reddy, and the minority government phase.
1971 Elections & Restoration	The 1971 Fifth Lok Sabha elections — the Grand Alliance vs. "Garibi Hatao", the 1971 Bangladesh Liberation War, and the altered nature of the Congress system.	Evaluating the transformation of the Congress system from an inclusive consensus umbrella to a centralized command hierarchy.

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EXAM TIP

High-Scoring Insight & Key Cognitive Traps for CUET UG:

- **The Succession Distinctions:** Jawaharlal Nehru died on 27 May 1964. Gulzarilal Nanda was sworn in as caretaker/interim Prime Minister on two separate occasions (after Nehru's death in May 1964 and after Shastri's death in January 1966), but Lal Bahadur Shastri and Indira Gandhi were the substantive Prime Ministers chosen through formal party procedures.
- **The 1967 Assembly Losses:** Congress failed to win a majority in 7 state assemblies directly at the polls (Punjab, Haryana, UP, Bihar, West Bengal, Orissa, Madras, and Kerala—in Kerala Congress failed to win earlier; in Madras DMK won a clear majority alone; in Haryana, Congress won a majority but lost power immediately due to post-poll defections). Thus, 8 non-Congress governments were formed.
- **Congress (O) vs. Congress (R):** Never confuse the factions! Congress (Organisation), also called the "Old Congress", was headed by S. Nijalingappa and the Syndicate. Congress (Requisitionists), or the "New Congress", was led by Indira Gandhi.

- **1971 Election Geometry:** Indira's Congress (R) secured 352 seats on its own and 375 seats with its ally CPI, while the four-party Grand Alliance collapsed.

The Succession Trials: 1964 and 1966

The decade of the 1960s was labeled by contemporary political observers, journalists, and Western commentators as the "dangerous decade". Severe doubts were voiced across international capitals regarding whether Indian democracy could survive the demise of Jawaharlal Nehru, who had personified the post-independence state since 1947. Critics feared that, like many newly decolonised nations across Asia and Africa, India would slide into military dictatorship, communal chaos, political fragmentation, or violent regional balkanisation.

The First Transition: Lal Bahadur Shastri (1964–1966)

When Jawaharlal Nehru passed away on 27 May 1964, the succession was managed with remarkable institutional maturity and constitutional propriety.

- **The Role of the Syndicate and Kamaraj:** K. Kamaraj, the President of the All India Congress Committee (AICC) and former Chief Minister of Madras, had initiated the historic "Kamaraj Plan" in 1963. Under this proposal, senior Union cabinet ministers and state Chief Ministers voluntarily resigned their executive posts to dedicate themselves to grassroots party revitalisation. Following Nehru's demise, Kamaraj acted as the chief orchestrator of succession, conducting exhaustive consultations with Congress Members of Parliament, state Chief Ministers, and Provincial Congress Committees.
- **The Consensus Choice:** Lal Bahadur Shastri was chosen unanimously by the Congress Parliamentary Party. Shastri was universally respected for his unblemished personal integrity, self-effacing humility, administrative acumen (having previously resigned as Union Railway Minister taking moral responsibility for the Ariyalur train disaster in 1956), and deep commitment to Nehruvian democratic values. Gulzarilal Nanda served temporarily as caretaker Prime Minister for a few days until Shastri was formally sworn in.
- **Dual Crises of Shastri's Tenure:** Shastri faced two acute existential crises during his brief 19-month premiership:
  1. **Agrarian Food Crisis:** Severe droughts in 1965 led to plummeting agricultural production, requiring heavy dependence on American food shipments under Public Law 480 (PL-480) and prompting widespread food rationing in urban centers.
  2. **The 1965 Indo-Pak War:** In August–September 1965, Pakistan launched armed incursions in the Rann of Kutch followed by Operation Grand Slam targeting Jammu and Kashmir. Shastri authorised the Indian armed forces to cross the International Border towards Lahore and Sialkot, demonstrating decisive strategic leadership.
- **The National Slogan:** During this dual crisis, Shastri coined the iconic slogan **"Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan"** (Hail the Soldier, Hail the Farmer), symbolising the twin pillars of national survival: sovereign territorial defense and agrarian self-sufficiency.
- **Tashkent Agreement and Sudden Demise:** Under Soviet diplomatic mediation led by Premier Alexei Kosygin, Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri and Pakistani President Muhammad Ayub Khan signed the historic Tashkent Agreement on 10 January 1966, agreeing to restore bilateral relations and withdraw armed personnel to pre-war positions. Tragically, Shastri suffered a sudden fatal cardiac arrest in Tashkent hours after signing the treaty.

The Second Transition: Indira Gandhi vs. Morarji Desai (1966)

The second succession within two years presented a direct electoral contest rather than a consensus:

- **The Contest:** Morarji Desai, former Chief Minister of Bombay and a veteran senior administrator with rigid principles, insisted on contesting the leadership. Indira Gandhi, daughter of Jawaharlal Nehru and then Minister of Information and Broadcasting in Shastri's cabinet, was backed by the Congress Syndicate.
- **The Secret Ballot:** On 19 January 1966, a democratic secret ballot was conducted among Congress Members of Parliament. Indira Gandhi secured a decisive victory, winning 355 votes against Morarji Desai's 169 votes.
- **Syndicate's Strategic Calculation:** The senior party bosses backing Indira—principally K. Kamaraj, S. Nijalingappa, S.K. Patil, and Atulya Ghosh—assumed that her relative youth and lack of administrative experience would compel her to remain dependent on their political guidance and organizational machinery. The socialist leader Rammanohar Lohia famously termed her a **"Gungi Gudiya"** (mute doll), believing she would function as a docile front for the Syndicate.

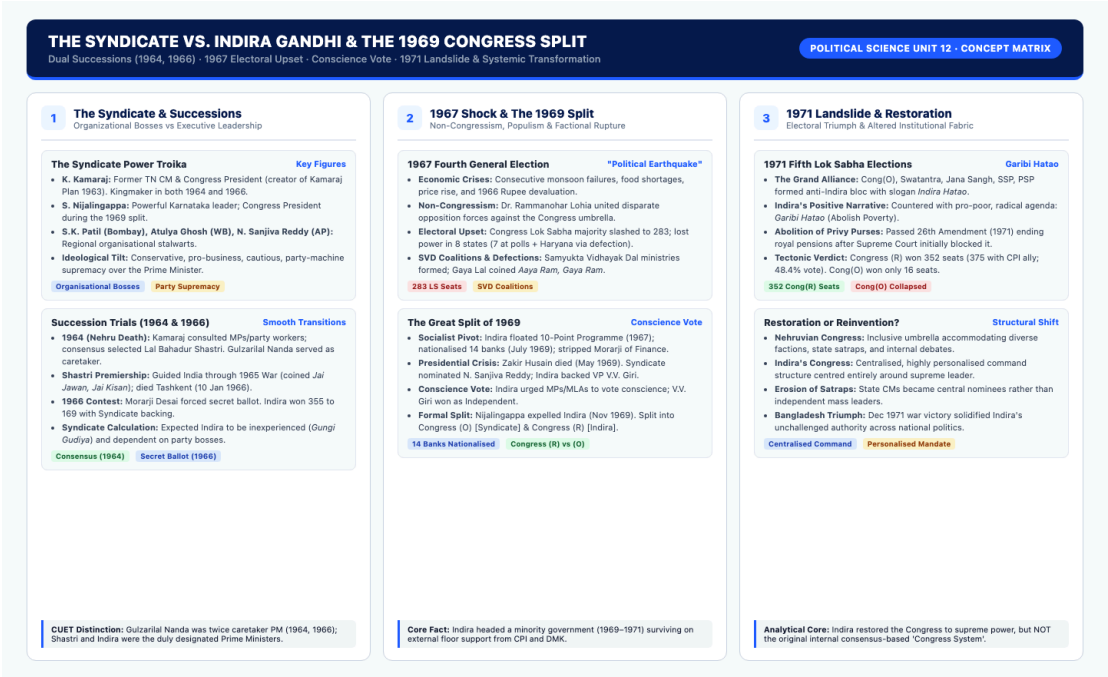


Figure 1: Figure 1 — The Syndicate vs. Indira Gandhi & The 1969 Congress Split: Organisational bosses, ideological polarisation, 1967 electoral shock, conscience vote duel, and the structural transformation of Indian democracy.

The Fourth General Elections (1967): The "Political Earthquake"

The year 1967 marks a watershed in Indian political history. The Fourth General Elections held in February 1967 were conducted in an environment of unprecedented socioeconomic distress and political volatility.

Socioeconomic Backdrop of the 1967 Elections

1. **Consecutive Monsoon Failures:** Severe nationwide droughts in 1965–1966 and 1966–1967 led to agricultural collapse, famine-like conditions in Bihar, and food rationing.
2. **Devaluation of the Indian Rupee:** In June 1966, under heavy pressure from the World Bank and the United States (which tied food shipments to structural reforms), the Indira Gandhi government devalued the Indian Rupee. The exchange rate dropped from approximately 4.76

rupees per US dollar to over 7.50 rupees per US dollar. This triggered sharp domestic inflation, spiking prices of essential consumer commodities, fuels, and manufactured imports.

3. **Popular Mobilisation and Protests:** Widespread industrial strikes, bandhs, student demonstrations, and agrarian agitations erupted across the country. The government frequently responded with law-and-order crackdowns, deepening public alienation.

The Ideology of "Non-Congressism"

Dr. Rammanohar Lohia, the foremost socialist theoretician and leader of the Samyukta Socialist Party (SSP), provided the philosophical and tactical justification for anti-Congress opposition unity:

- **The Core Thesis:** Lohia argued that the Congress government was undemocratic, elitist, and run in the interests of a tiny affluent minority while neglecting the impoverished 90% of the population.
- **Opposition Fragmentation:** He demonstrated that the Congress repeatedly captured overwhelming parliamentary majorities (over 70% of seats) on the basis of a divided opposition vote, even though its actual national popular vote share rarely exceeded 45%.
- **The Call for Non-Congressism:** Lohia urged non-Congress parties—spanning the ideological spectrum from the right-wing Swatantra Party and Hindu nationalist Bharatiya Jana Sangh to the left-wing Socialists and Communists—to form strategic electoral pacts, avoid splitting the anti-Congress vote, and present a direct bipolar contest in every constituency.

The Electoral Verdict and Its Significance

The election results of February 1967 were widely described by political analysts as an electoral and "political earthquake":

- **Lok Sabha Majority Slashed:** Congress managed to retain power at the Centre, but its tally plummeted to 283 seats out of 520 (down from 361 in 1962), its lowest ever since 1952. Several of Indira Gandhi's senior cabinet ministers were defeated.
- **Defeat of the Syndicate Stalwarts:** The organisational bosses of the Syndicate suffered humiliating personal defeats in their own home bastions:
  - K. Kamaraj lost in Madras (Virudhunagar) to a student leader of the DMK.
  - S.K. Patil was defeated in Bombay.
  - Atulya Ghosh lost in West Bengal.
  - K.B. Sahay was defeated in Bihar.
- **Loss of State Assemblies:** Congress lost power in eight states:
  - In Madras (Tamil Nadu), C.N. Annadurai led the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) to a historic victory, securing a clear majority on its own by spearheading the anti-Hindi agitations of 1965. This was the first time a regional party captured an absolute majority in a state assembly without any coalition partner.
  - In Kerala, an anti-Congress United Front led by the CPI(M) under E.M.S. Namboodiripad swept to power.
  - In Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, and Orissa, non-Congress coalition ministries assumed office.

Coalitions and Defections: The SVD Phenomenon

The 1967 elections dismantled the single-party dominance of the Congress and inaugurated the era of coalition politics at the state level.

Samyukta Vidhayak Dal (SVD) Ministries

Because no single opposition party secured an absolute majority in most northern states, diverse non-Congress legislative parties came together to form joint legislative fronts known as the **Samyukta Vidhayak Dal** (SVD):

- **Ideological Incoherence:** These coalitions brought together bitter ideological antagonists. In Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, the SVD governments included both the right-wing Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS) and the socialist SSP, along with the Communist Party of India (CPI) and conservative agrarian defectors.
- **Agrarian Leadership:** In Uttar Pradesh, senior Congress leader Chaudhary Charan Singh broke away from the Congress, formed the Bharatiya Kranti Dal (BKD), and became the Chief Minister of the first non-Congress government in India's most populous state.
- **Instability of SVD Governments:** Bound together solely by negative anti-Congressism rather than a shared socioeconomic programme, the SVD ministries suffered from perpetual internal friction, frequent cabinet boycotts, and chronic instability. Most SVD governments collapsed within one to two years, paving the way for repeated mid-term elections and President's Rule under Article 356.

The Menace of Political Defection: "Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram"

The post-1967 landscape was severely corrupted by the unchecked practice of political defection, wherein elected legislators abandoned the party on whose ticket and symbol they were elected to join another party or coalition in exchange for ministerial portfolios, cash inducements, or executive patronage:

- **The Origin of the Phrase:** The legendary phrase **"Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram"** originated in the newly created state of Haryana. In 1967, an independent/Congress MLA named Gaya Lal changed his party affiliation three times within a single fortnight (moving from Congress to the United Front, back to Congress within nine hours, and then back to the United Front within a few days!).
- **Rao Birender Singh's Press Conference:** When Congress leader Rao Birender Singh brought Gaya Lal back to Chandigarh, he announced to the press: **"Gaya Ram is now Aaya Ram"**. The phrase became a permanent fixture in Indian political discourse to describe unprincipled political opportunism.
- **Constitutional Vulnerability:** Defections directly brought down stable governments in Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, and Madhya Pradesh. It was not until the 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1985 that the Tenth Schedule (Anti-Defection Law) was enacted to curb this systemic subversion.

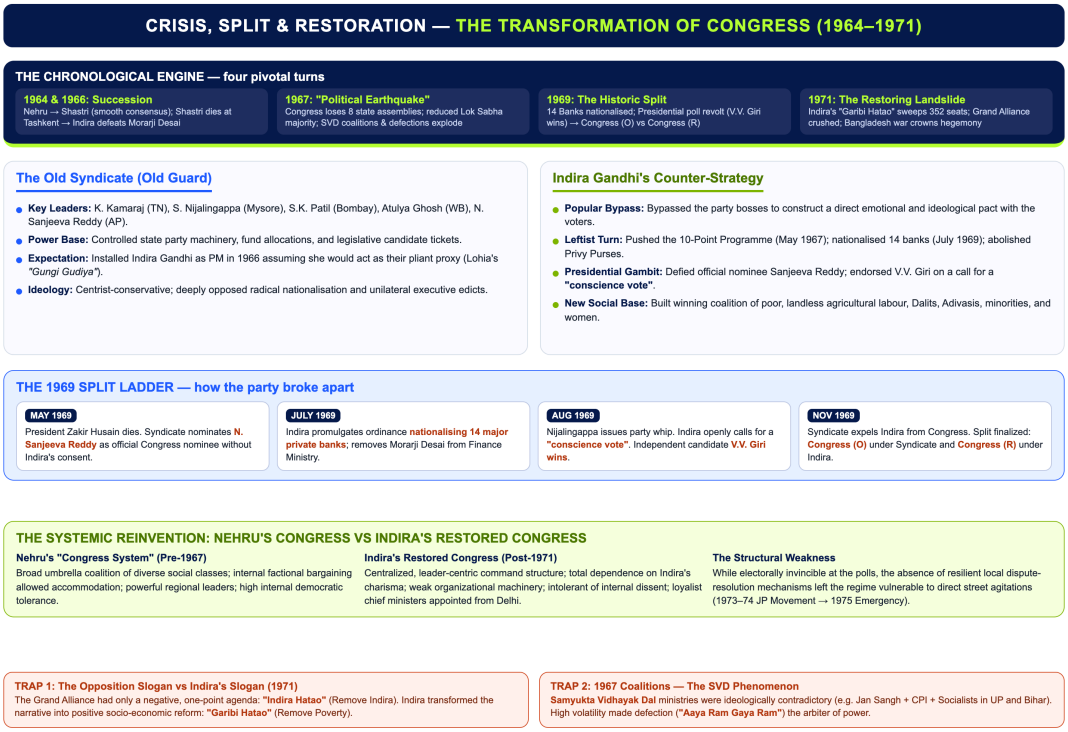


Figure 2: Figure 2 — The Congress Crisis & Restoration Engine (1964–1971): Dual succession, the 1967 electoral upset, the 1969 factional split, and the transformation from Nehru's umbrella party to Indira's centralized socialist command structure.

The Split in the Congress (1969)

The underlying conflict between Prime Minister Indira Gandhi and the organizational bosses of the Syndicate reached a climactic breaking point between 1967 and 1969. The struggle was simultaneously a raw contest for political supremacy and an intense ideological confrontation over economic policy.

The Leftward Socialist Pivot & The Ten-Point Programme

Following the electoral setback of 1967, Indira Gandhi realised that relying on the conservative party machinery would leave her vulnerable. She decided to bypass the Syndicate by adopting a radical, pro-poor socialist posture:

- **The Ten-Point Programme (May 1967):** Indira persuaded the Congress Working Committee (CWC) to adopt a radical 10-point socialist agenda, which included:
  1. Social control of banking institutions.
  2. Nationalisation of general insurance.
  3. Ceiling on urban property and unearned income.
  4. Public distribution of foodgrains.
  5. Rapid implementation of agricultural land ceilings.
  6. Provision of housing sites to rural landless laborers.
  7. Abolition of Privy Purses and princely privileges.
- **The "Young Turks" Faction:** A vocal group of younger, ideological socialist Congressmen known as the "Young Turks"—prominently including Chandra Shekhar, Mohan Dharia, Krishan Kant, and Ram Dhan—exerted relentless pressure on the government to dismantle monopolies, nationalise credit, and cancel the royal privy purses.

- **Bangalore AICC Session (July 1969):** Indira Gandhi submitted a historic policy memorandum titled **"Stray Thoughts on Bank Nationalisation and Radical Economic Policies"**.
- **The Bank Nationalisation Ordinance:** Immediately following the session, on 19 July 1969, Indira Gandhi promulgated an executive ordinance nationalising 14 major private commercial banks (each having deposits exceeding Rs 50 crore). She also stripped Deputy Prime Minister and Finance Minister Morarji Desai of the Finance portfolio, prompting his resignation from the Union Cabinet.

The 1969 Presidential Election: The "Conscience Vote"

The flashpoint for the final rupture arrived with the sudden death of President Dr. Zakir Husain in May 1969:

- **Syndicate's Candidate:** The Syndicate Parliamentary Board, outvoting Indira Gandhi, nominated Neelam Sanjiva Reddy (then Speaker of the Lok Sabha and a long-time member of the Syndicate) as the official Congress candidate for the presidency.
- **Indira's Counter-Strategy:** Indira Gandhi refused to be politically cornered. She privately encouraged the incumbent Vice-President, Varahagiri Venkata Giri (V.V. Giri), to resign his office and enter the presidential fray as an Independent candidate.
- **The "Conscience Vote" Call:** Congress President S. Nijalingappa issued a formal party whip directing all Congress MPs and MLAs to vote strictly for the official candidate, N. Sanjiva Reddy. In response, Indira Gandhi made a historic public broadcast calling for a **"free vote of conscience"**, arguing that legislators should vote according to their inner moral convictions rather than mechanical party directives.
- **The Tectonic Result:** In an unprecedented electoral drama, V.V. Giri secured victory on second-preference votes, defeating the official nominee Sanjiva Reddy.
- **The Formal Split (November 1969):** Enraged by this open defiance, Congress President Nijalingappa formally expelled Prime Minister Indira Gandhi from the Indian National Congress on 12 November 1969 for gross anti-party indiscipline.
- **Two Congress Parties:**
  - **Congress (Organisation) [Congress (O)]:** Led by the Syndicate (Nijalingappa, Kamaraj, Morarji Desai, S.K. Patil). Often called the "Old Congress".
  - **Congress (Requisitionists) [Congress (R)]:** Led by Indira Gandhi and her progressive supporters. Often called the "New Congress".
- **The Minority Government Phase (1969–1971):** Although the split reduced Indira Gandhi's government to a minority in the Lok Sabha, her ministry survived comfortably due to issue-based floor support extended by the Communist Party of India (CPI), the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), and several progressive independent members.

The 1971 General Elections & "Garibi Hatao"

To free herself from dependence on coalition partners and secure a definitive national mandate, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi took a bold strategic gamble in December 1970 by recommending the premature dissolution of the Fifth Lok Sabha—the first time a parliamentary term was dissolved early in Indian history.

The Political Geometry: The Grand Alliance vs. Indira Gandhi

The Fifth General Elections of March 1971 pitted two fundamentally distinct political forces against each other:

- **The Grand Alliance:** Congress (O) entered into a comprehensive national electoral alliance with major non-communist opposition parties, including the conservative Swatantra Party, the right-wing Bharatiya Jana Sangh, and the socialist Samyukta Socialist Party (SSP) and Praja Socialist Party (PSP).
  - **The Grand Alliance's Narrative:** The opposition campaign was built entirely on a negative, single-point personal agenda: **"Indira Hatao"** (Remove Indira). They possessed no coherent common minimum socioeconomic programme.
- **Indira's Positive Narrative: "Garibi Hatao":** Indira Gandhi brilliantly converted the campaign into an ideological referendum on poverty alleviation and social justice. She famously countered the opposition slogan with her clarion call: **"Woh kehte hain Indira Hatao, main kehti hoon Garibi Hatao"** (They say remove Indira, I say abolish poverty!).
- **Targeted Social Coalition:** Indira built a broad subaltern electoral coalition comprising the rural landless, Dalits (Scheduled Castes), Adivasis (Scheduled Tribes), religious minorities (especially Muslims), unorganised laborers, and women, who perceived her as their direct champion against entrenched feudal and upper-caste village elites.

Abolition of Privy Purses: Constitutional and Political Climax

The abolition of Privy Purses was a decisive populist weapon deployed by Indira Gandhi:

- **Historical Origin:** During the integration of 565 princely states in 1947–1949, Sardar Patel had negotiated treaties offering former hereditary rulers lifelong tax-free privy purses, titles, and special privileges in exchange for surrendering their territorial sovereignty.
- **Socialist Critique:** Nehru and progressive leaders had long viewed privy purses as anachronistic relics of feudalism incompatible with the democratic ideal of egalitarian citizenship.
- **The Legislative and Judicial Battle:**
  - In 1970, the government introduced a constitutional amendment bill to abolish privy purses. It passed the Lok Sabha with a two-thirds majority but fell short by a single vote in the Rajya Sabha.
  - The government then issued a presidential derecognition order de-recognising all former princes.
  - In December 1970, the Supreme Court of India in the landmark **Madhav Rao Scindia v. Union of India** case struck down the presidential order as unconstitutional.
- **The 26th Amendment (1971):** Following her landslide victory in 1971, Indira Gandhi passed the 26th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1971, which formally abolished Articles 291 and 362, terminating all privy purses and sovereign privileges permanently.

The 1971 Landslide and Bangladesh Triumph

The election results of March 1971 stunned observers and shattered the Grand Alliance:

- **Congress (R) Sweeps:** Indira Gandhi's Congress (R) won 352 seats on its own (43.7% popular vote) and, along with its ally CPI (23 seats), commanded a massive two-thirds majority of 375 seats in the Lok Sabha.
- **Decimation of the Syndicate:** Congress (O) was decimated, securing just 16 seats with a meager 10.4% vote share. The Grand Alliance parties were routed across their traditional strongholds.
- **Indo-Pak War and Bangladesh Liberation (December 1971):** The victory was consecrated months later when the Indian armed forces under Prime Minister Indira Gandhi intervened in East Pakistan, decisively defeating the Pakistani military, liberating 75 million Bengalis, and midwiving the sovereign state of Bangladesh.

- **1972 State Assembly Sweeps:** In the state assembly elections held in early 1972, Congress (R) swept back to power across virtually every state, establishing undisputed political dominance across the length and breadth of India.

Restoration or Reinvention? The Changed Congress System

Political scientists, most notably Rajni Kothari, had described the first two decades of Indian democracy as the **"Congress System"**—a pluralist "party of consensus" that operated as a broad umbrella accommodating diverse social groups, ideologies, and regional factions. When Indira Gandhi secured her sweeping victories in 1971 and 1972, did she restore this classic Congress system, or did she invent a radically different institution?

The Fundamental Differences Between Nehru's and Indira's Congress

Structural Dimension	Nehruvian Congress System (1947–1964)	Indira's Restored Congress (Post-1971)
Internal Factionalism	Encouraged as an internal feedback mechanism; factions negotiated consensus within the party umbrella.	Suppressed; factions were viewed as anti-party conspiracies; supreme leader demanded absolute personal loyalty.
State Party Leadership	Headed by powerful regional satraps (e.g., Kamaraj, B.C. Roy, Chavan) with independent mass bases.	Regional satraps dismantled; Chief Ministers were handpicked by New Delhi as loyal central nominees.
Ideological Orientation	Centrist, eclectic, pragmatically accommodating left, right, and capitalist-landlord interests.	Radical pro-poor socialist rhetoric (**Garibi Hatao**), public-sector dominance, and subaltern mobilisation.
Institutional Intermediaries	Vibrant local and district party committees acting as democratic grievance transmission channels.	Erosion of party organisation; reliance on direct plebiscitary appeals by the supreme leader via mass media.
Bureaucratic & Judicial Norms	Autonomous, neutral civil service and independent judiciary anchored in constitutional formalism.	Demands for a "committed bureaucracy" and "committed judiciary" aligned with the ruling party's socialist goals.

Institutional Consequences of the Transformation

While Indira Gandhi dramatically restored the electoral supremacy of the Congress, she radically altered its organizational DNA:

1. **Loss of Absorptive Capacity:** The old Congress system was able to absorb social discontent and co-opt rising regional forces through internal factional compromise. The new centralised structure lacked local roots and could no longer absorb popular agitations peacefully.
2. **Dependence on Charisma:** The entire legitimacy of the party rested exclusively on the personal charisma and populist appeal of Indira Gandhi. When economic conditions deteriorated following the 1973 global oil shock and severe droughts, the unmediated popular anger targeted the Prime Minister directly.

3. **Path to Authoritarianism:** The suppression of internal party democracy and institutional checks set the stage for intense confrontation between the executive and the judiciary, culminating in the declaration of the National Emergency in June 1975.
4. **Erosion of Federal Autonomy:** State governments became increasingly subordinate to directives from the Prime Minister's Secretariat (PMO). Governors were routinely employed to dismiss recalcitrant state ministries under Article 356.
5. **The Paradox of Populism:** The rhetoric of **Garibi Hatao** aroused massive socioeconomic expectations among marginalized classes. When structural poverty, land reforms, and job creation stalled due to administrative inertia and economic inflation, public frustration boiled over into mass street protests across Gujarat and Bihar.

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Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap

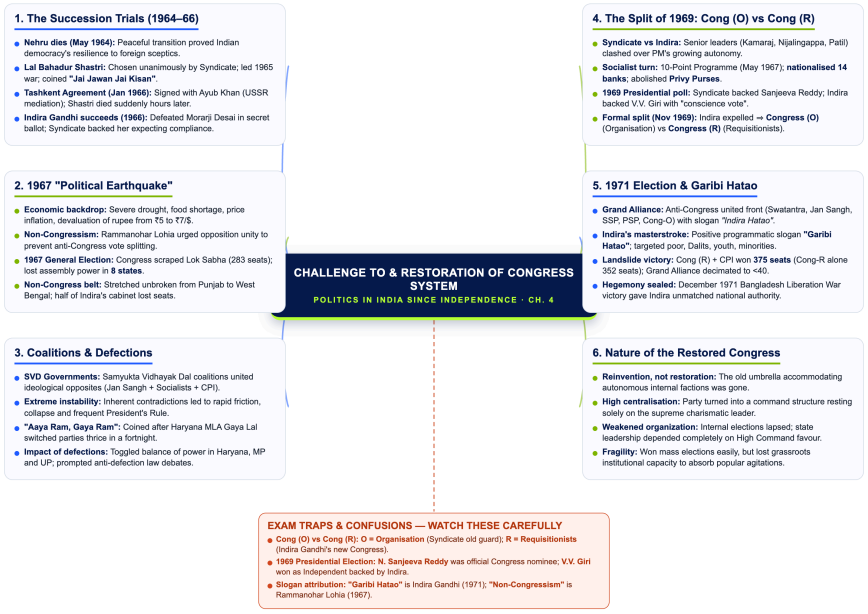


Figure 3: Figure 3 — Challenge to and Restoration of the Congress System Mindmap: Complete structural map of the succession trials, 1967 electoral shock, 1969 factional split, and 1971 Garibi Hatao restoration.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **Succession Chronology:** Nehru passes away (**27 May 1964**) → Lal Bahadur Shastri becomes PM (June 1964) → Tashkent Agreement & Shastri's demise (**10 Jan 1966**) → Indira Gandhi defeats Morarji Desai (**19 Jan 1966**).
- **The Syndicate Bosses:** K. Kamaraj (Tamil Nadu, Kamaraj Plan 1963), S.K. Patil (Bombay), S. Nijalingappa (Karnataka), Atulya Ghosh (West Bengal), N. Sanjiva Reddy (Andhra Pradesh).
- **1967 General Election:** "Political Earthquake"; Congress won **283 Lok Sabha seats**; lost power in **8 states**; DMK became first regional party to win standalone assembly majority (Madras).
- **Non-Congressism:** Coined by socialist thinker **Dr. Rammanohar Lohia** to unite anti-Congress opposition votes.
- **Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram:** Coined by **Rao Birender Singh** in Haryana after MLA **Gaya Lal** defected 3 times in a fortnight.
- **14 Banks Nationalisation:** Promulgated via Ordinance on **19 July 1969**; Morarji Desai resigned as Finance Minister.
- **1969 Presidential Duel:** Official nominee **N. Sanjiva Reddy** vs Independent **V.V. Giri**; Giri won on second preferences via "conscience vote".
- **Congress Split (Nov 1969):** Congress (O) [Organisation / Syndicate] vs Congress (R) [Requisitionists / Indira Gandhi].
- **26th Amendment (1971):** Abolished **Privy Purses** and royal titles granted during princely integration.
- **1971 Landslide:** Congress (R) won **352 seats** (375 with CPI ally); Congress (O) reduced to **16 seats**.

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — CONGRESS CRISIS & RESTORATION

▸**Succession Trials:** 1964 (Nehru death → Kamaraj consensus → Shastri sworn in → 1965 War & "Jai Jawan Jai Kisan" → Tashkent 10 Jan 1966) → 1966 (Morarji contest → Secret ballot 355–169 → Indira PM → "Gungi Gudiya" miscalculation). ▸**1967 Political Earthquake:** Rupee devalued June 1966 (4.76 to 7.50/USD) → Dr. Rammanohar Lohia's "Non-Congressism" → Congress LS tally slashed to 283 → Lost power in 8 states → SVD coalitions in north India → "Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram" (Gaya Lal, Haryana) → Charan Singh forms BKD in UP. ▸**Radical Socialist Turn & 1969 Split:** May 1967 10-Point Programme → July 1969 Bangalore AICC & "Stray Thoughts" → 14 Commercial Banks nationalised → Morarji resigns → President Zakir Husain dies (May 1969) → Syndicate nominates Sanjiva Reddy → Indira backs V.V. Giri → "Conscience Vote" broadcast → V.V. Giri wins → Nijalingappa expels Indira → Congress(O) vs Congress(R) → Minority govt survives with CPI & DMK floor support. ▸**1971 Landslide & Restoration:** Dec 1970 LS dissolution → Grand Alliance (Cong(O) + Swatantra + Jana Sangh + SSP) slogan: "Indira Hatao" → Indira counters with "Garibi Hatao" → 26th Amendment (1971) abolishes Privy Purses → Congress(R) wins 352 seats (375 with CPI) → Bangladesh War (Dec 1971) → 1972 Assembly sweep → Transformation into centralized command structure.

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **Interim PM vs Substantive PM:** Gulzarilal Nanda was twice interim/caretaker PM (1964, 1966); Shastri and Indira were the formally elected substantive Prime Ministers.
2. **State Assembly Losses in 1967:** Congress failed to win majority in **7 states** at polls, plus **Haryana** lost via post-poll defection, creating **8 non-Congress governments**.
3. **DMK Standalone Majority:** In Madras (1967), DMK won an **absolute standalone majority** (137/234 seats), NOT a coalition. First regional party to do so.
4. **Congress (O) vs Congress (R):** Congress (O) = Organisation (Syndicate bosses); Congress (R) = Requisitionists (Indira Gandhi's new party).
5. **1969 Presidential Duel:** N. Sanjiva Reddy was the official nominee who **lost**; V.V. Giri was the Independent candidate who **won** on second-preference votes.
6. **Privy Purses Abolition:** Struck down by Supreme Court in **Madhav Rao Scindia (1970)**; abolished permanently by the **26th Amendment Act (1971)**.
7. **Restored vs Original System:** Indira restored Congress **electoral dominance**, but NOT the inclusive internal-consensus umbrella described by Rajni Kothari.

Practice Questions (Exam Pattern)

Fifteen authentic CUET UG examination-standard multiple-choice questions testing conceptual, chronological, institutional, and factual mastery. Marking scheme: +5 for correct answer, −1 for incorrect attempt.

Part 1: Successions, 1967 Earthquake & Non-Congressism

Q1. Who succeeded Jawaharlal Nehru as the Prime Minister of India in June 1964 following a consensus process led by Congress President K. Kamaraj?

(A) Morarji Desai (B) Gulzarilal Nanda
(C) Lal Bahadur Shastri (D) C. Rajagopalachari

Sol. Q1. Lal Bahadur Shastri was unanimously chosen as Prime Minister in June 1964 following extensive party consultations conducted by Congress President K. Kamaraj. Gulzarilal Nanda served merely as interim caretaker for a few days. **Answer: (C)**

Q2. The historic slogan "Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan" was coined by Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri during which critical phase?

(A) The 1962 Sino-Indian War (B) The 1965 Indo-Pak War and acute agrarian food crisis
(C) The launch of the Second Five Year Plan (D) The 1967 General Elections

Sol. Q2. Shastri coined "Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan" during the 1965 war with Pakistan to salute the dual pillars of national defense and food self-sufficiency during severe agrarian distress. **Answer: (B)**

Q3. The doctrine of "Non-Congressism", arguing that opposition parties must unite to overthrow Congress dominance because it was undemocratic and pro-rich, was propounded by:

(A) Dr. Rammanohar Lohia (B) Jayaprakash Narayan
(C) Acharya J.B. Kripalani (D) C.N. Annadurai

Sol. Q3. Dr. Rammanohar Lohia, the eminent socialist theoretician, formulated the concept of "Non-Congressism" to consolidate the fragmented opposition vote and overthrow the Congress monopoly. **Answer: (A)**

Q4. In the 1967 Fourth General Elections, how many state legislative assemblies saw Congress lose power, leading to the creation of SVD coalition ministries?

(A) Four states (B) Six states
(C) Eight states (7 at polls + Haryana through defection) (D) Eleven states

Sol. Q4. Congress failed to win an absolute majority in 7 states at the polls (Punjab, Haryana, UP, Bihar, WB, Orissa, Madras, and Kerala previously), and lost Haryana immediately via defection, creating 8 non-Congress state governments. **Answer: (C)**

Q5. The notorious political catchphrase "Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram" was coined by Rao Birender Singh after an MLA named Gaya Lal repeatedly defected between parties in which state?

(A) Punjab (B) Haryana
(C) Uttar Pradesh (D) Rajasthan

Sol. Q5. Gaya Lal was an MLA from Hassanpur in Haryana who defected three times within a fortnight in 1967, prompting Rao Birender Singh's famous press quip "Gaya Ram is now Aaya Ram". **Answer: (B)**

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Part 2: The Great Split of 1969 & Minority Governance

Q6. In July 1969, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi initiated a dramatic leftward policy shift by promulgating an ordinance that nationalised how many major commercial banks?

(A) 14 major commercial banks
(B) 10 major commercial banks
(C) 20 major commercial banks
(D) 8 major commercial banks

Sol. Q6. Indira Gandhi promulgated an executive ordinance on 19 July 1969 nationalising 14 major private commercial banks with deposits exceeding Rs 50 crore, leading to the resignation of Morarji Desai. **Answer: (A)**

Q7. In the watershed 1969 Presidential Election, who won as an Independent candidate supported by Indira Gandhi's call for a "conscience vote", defeating official nominee N. Sanjiva Reddy?

(A) Dr. Zakir Husain
(B) V.V. Giri
(C) Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed
(D) Giani Zail Singh

Sol. Q7. Vice-President V.V. Giri contested as an Independent and won on second-preference votes after Indira Gandhi urged MPs and MLAs to cast a "conscience vote" against official nominee Sanjiva Reddy. **Answer: (B)**

Q8. Following the formal split of the Indian National Congress in November 1969, what was the official designation given to the faction led by the Syndicate?

(A) Congress (Requisitionists)
(B) Congress (Indira)
(C) Congress (Secular)
(D) Congress (Organisation)

Sol. Q8. The faction led by the Syndicate bosses (S. Nijalingappa, K. Kamaraj, Morarji Desai) was officially designated Congress (Organisation) or Congress (O), while Indira's party was Congress (R). **Answer: (D)**

Q9. What was the central pro-poor slogan deployed by Indira Gandhi's Congress (R) in the 1971 Fifth Lok Sabha elections to counter the Grand Alliance's slogan "Indira Hatao"?

(A) Garibi Hatao (Abolish Poverty)
(B) Jai Jawan Jai Kisan
(C) Sampoorn Kranti
(D) Congress Lao, Desh Bachao

Sol. Q9. Indira Gandhi electrified the electorate by countering the opposition's negative "Indira Hatao" with her transformative, pro-poor positive campaign pledge: "Garibi Hatao" (Abolish Poverty). **Answer: (A)**

Q10. In the 1971 Fifth General Elections, how many seats did Indira Gandhi's Congress (R) secure on its own in the Lok Sabha?

(A) 283 seats
(B) 315 seats
(C) 352 seats (375 along with ally CPI)
(D) 414 seats

Sol. Q10. Congress (R) secured a staggering 352 seats on its own (and 375 together with ally CPI), completely destroying the Grand Alliance and proving that Indira's party was the real Congress. **Answer: (C)**

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Part 3: Institutional Transformation & Core Analysis

Q11. Which constitutional amendment abolished the Privy Purses and privileges guaranteed to the former rulers of princely states in 1971?

(A) 24th Amendment Act
(B) 26th Amendment Act
(C) 42nd Amendment Act
(D) 44th Amendment Act

Sol. Q11. The 26th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1971, abolished Articles 291 and 362 of the Constitution, permanently ending all privy purses and special royal titles granted to former princes. **Answer: (B)**

Q12. The Samyukta Vidhayak Dal (SVD) coalition government formed in Uttar Pradesh in 1967 was headed by which prominent agrarian leader who defected from the Congress?

(A) Chaudhary Charan Singh
(B) Chaudhary Devi Lal
(C) Karpoori Thakur
(D) Chandra Shekhar

Sol. Q12. Chaudhary Charan Singh broke away from the Congress party to establish the Bharatiya Kranti Dal (BKD) and headed the landmark SVD coalition ministry in Uttar Pradesh in 1967. **Answer: (A)**

Q13. The "Kamaraj Plan", formulated in 1963 to revitalise the Congress organisation, proposed that:

(A) All opposition parties should merge with the Congress
(B) The Prime Minister must be directly elected by the public
(C) The Planning Commission should be dissolved
(D) Senior cabinet ministers and Chief Ministers should resign government office to dedicate themselves to grassroots party work

Sol. Q13. Under the Kamaraj Plan of 1963, senior national ministers and state Chief Ministers resigned their government posts to undertake organizational work, inadvertently elevating Kamaraj as party kingmaker. **Answer: (D)**

Q14. Which of the following was NOT a member of the "Syndicate"—the powerful informal group of senior regional leaders within the Congress during the mid-1960s?

(A) K. Kamaraj
(B) S.K. Patil
(C) Jayaprakash Narayan
(D) Atulya Ghosh

Sol. Q14. Jayaprakash Narayan was a socialist leader who had renounced active party politics for the Sarvodaya movement, not a member of the Congress Syndicate (which comprised Kamaraj, Patil, Ghosh, Nijalingappa, etc.). **Answer: (C)**

Q15. How did the restored Congress system under Indira Gandhi fundamentally differ from the original "Congress System" conceptualised by political scientist Rajni Kothari?

(A) It transitioned from a democratic republic to a constitutional monarchy
(B) It banned all opposition political parties from contesting elections
(C) It abandoned parliamentary democracy in favor of a presidential system
(D) It replaced the multi-factional internal consensus umbrella with a highly centralised and personalised command hierarchy reliant on the supreme leader's charismatic mass appeal

Sol. Q15. While Rajni Kothari's original Congress System functioned as an inclusive umbrella accommodating diverse internal factions and regional satraps, Indira's restored Congress transformed into a highly centralized, personalized command structure reliant on her direct plebiscitary appeal. **Answer: (D)**

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